

Deal 1 Ctr: 6♥ Goal: at most ____ losers

A♥J♥9♥7♥3♥

A♣6♣

8♦3♦

K♠Q♠9♠4♠

K♥Q♥10♥4♥

K♣Q♣9♣8♣

A♥K♥7♥

10♠5♠

Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 3 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers

Q♠9♠8♠5♠3♠

7♥2♥

A♣3♣

8♦6♦4♦2♦

J♠10♠4♠

A♥K♥

K♣Q♣9♣8♣

A♥K♥9♥7♥

Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: South

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 3
♥ 6 5 2
♦ Q J 10 9 4
♣ J 10

♠ 10 5
♥ K Q 10 4
♦ A K 7
♣ K Q 9 8



♠ J 7 6 2
♥ 8
♦ 6 5 2
♣ 7 5 4 3 2

♠ K Q 9 4
♥ A J 9 7 3
♦ 8 3
♣ A 6

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♦	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by North			

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♦.

Just hold it a minute and DO NOT say 2♥. True, when partner transfers, you **almost** always just obey and complete the transfer. This is the one time when you don't. You had a 17 point 1NT opener with 4♥s and a doubleton. As soon as partner told you to bid ♥s your hand became worth 18 points because of the good trump support and the doubleton. So you inform partner of this by making the "super-accept" bid of 3♥. In other words, you complete the transfer with a jump.

Partner's eyes get big (but you aren't allowed to notice that) and he bids 4♣.

Partner's ♣ bid was not a suit, you already have an agreed suit, ♥s. The ♣ bid was showing you first round control in ♣s, and is a slam try by partner.

You continue the search for slam by showing your first round ♦ control, you bid 4♦.

That was all partner needed to hear, he jumps straight to 6♥.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 8 5 3

♥ 7 2

♦ 8 6 4 2

♣ A 3

♠ A K 7

♥ J 9 8 6 4

♦ 10

♣ J 7 5 2



♠ J 10 4

♥ A K

♦ A K 9 7

♣ K Q 9 8

♠ 6 2

♥ Q 10 5 3

♦ Q J 5 3

♣ 10 6 4

*West**North**East**South*

3♥

Pass

3♠

Pass

3NT

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

You open 2NT and partner responds 3♥.

You bid 3♠, just as partner asked. He puts you in game at 3NT. Bid or pass?

Bid of course. You have an 8-card ♠ fit so you prefer ♠s to notrump.

As you can see, 3NT would surely go down with a ♥ lead, while 4♠ is cold.

One hand doesn't mean it will always be like this, but usually if you have an 8-card fit the Major suit game will be better than 3NT.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 5 4 2

♥ 9 6 4

♦ Q 8 3

♣ A 9 5

♠ K 6

♥ A Q J 10 7

♦ 10 9 5

♣ K Q 3



♠ Q 8 7 3

♥ 2

♦ J 7 6 4 2

♣ 10 7 2

♠ A J 10

♥ K 8 5 3

♦ A K

♣ J 8 6 4

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by South			

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♦.

You are very close to being strong enough for a "Super-accept", but with this hand you should just complete the transfer to 2♥.

Partner now says 4NT.

If you don't remember Deal 9 go back and look at it now. Partner is not bidding Blackwood, he has about 16 points and is inviting you to bid a slam if you have a maximum. He is also telling you that he has just 5♥s and wants you to decide between the suit contract and notrump.

Once you understand partner's bid, your next move is simple. You have a maximum and you prefer to play in the suit. So you bid 6♥.